

104. Chapter 8 Verses 23-28

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 8.23

यत्र काले त्वनावृत्तिमावृत्तिं चैव योगिनः ।
प्रयाता यान्ति तं कालं वक्ष्यामि भरतर्षभ ॥ 23 ॥

yatra kāle tvanāvṛttim
āvṛttim caiva yoginaḥ |
prayātā yānti taṁ kālam
vakṣyāmi bharatarṣabha ||

- ◆ **yatra kāle** – at which time; **tu** – indeed; **anāvṛttim** – non-return;
- ◆ **āvṛttim** – return; **ca** – and; **eva** – also; **yoginaḥ** – Yogis;
- ◆ **prayātāḥ** – having departed; **yānti** – go to; **taṁ kālam** – that time;
- ◆ **vakṣyāmi** – I shall tell; **bharata-ṛṣabha** – O best of the Bharatas.

Now I will tell you, O greatest of the Bhāratas, the time in which the yogis depart never to return, and also the time in which they depart to return.

VERSE 8.24

अग्निर्ज्योतिरहः शुक्लः षण्मासा उत्तरायणम् ।
तत्र प्रयाता गच्छन्ति ब्रह्म ब्रह्मविदो जनाः ॥ 24 ॥

agnirjyotirahaḥ śuklaḥ
ṣaṇmāsā uttarāyaṇam |
tatra prayātā gacchanti
brahma brahmavido janāḥ ||

- ◆ **agniḥ** – fire; **jyotiḥ** – light; **ahaḥ** – day; **śuklaḥ** – the bright fortnight;
- ◆ **ṣaṭ-māsāḥ** – the six months; **uttara-ayaṇam** – the northern solstice;
- ◆ **tatra** – there/then; **prayātāḥ** – those who have departed; **gacchanti** – go to;
- ◆ **brahma** – Brahman; **brahma-vidaḥ** – knowers of Brahman; **janāḥ** – people.

Fire, light, day-time, the bright half of the moon, and the six months of the northward passage of the sun— taking this path, the knowers of Brahman go to Brahman.

VERSE 8.25

धूमो रात्रिस्तथा कृष्णः षण्मासा दक्षिणायनम् ।
तत्र चान्द्रमसं ज्योतिर्योगी प्राप्य निवर्तते ॥ 25 ॥

dhūmo rātristathā kṛṣṇaḥ
ṣaṇmāsā dakṣiṇāyanam |
tatra cāndramasaṃ jyotir
yogī prāpya nivartate ||

- ◆ **dhūmaḥ** – smoke; **rātriḥ** – night; **tathā** – also; **kṛṣṇaḥ** – the dark fortnight;
- ◆ **ṣaṭ-māsāḥ** – the six months; **dakṣiṇa-ayaṇam** – the southern solstice;
- ◆ **tatra** – there; **cāndramasaṃ** – lunar; **jyotiḥ** – light;
- ◆ **yogī** – the Yogi; **prāpya** – having attained; **nivartate** – returns.

Smoke, night, the dark half of the moon, and the six months of the southward passage of the sun— taking this path, the yogi reaches the lunar path and thence returns.

VERSE 8.26

शुक्लकृष्णे गती ह्येते जगतः शाश्वते मते ।
एकया यात्यनावृत्तिमन्ययावर्तते पुनः ॥ 26 ॥

śukla-kṛṣṇe gatī hyete
jagataḥ śāśvate mate |
ekayā yātyanāvṛttim
anyayāvartate punaḥ ||

- ◆ **śukla-kṛṣṇe** – bright and dark; **gatī** – paths; **hi** – indeed; **ete** – these;
- ◆ **jagataḥ** – of the world; **śāśvate** – eternal; **mate** – are considered;
- ◆ **ekayā** – by one; **yāti** – one goes; **anāvṛttim** – to non-return;
- ◆ **anyayā** – by the other; **āvartate** – one returns; **punaḥ** – again.

These two paths— the bright and the dark— are deemed to be the world’s eternal paths. Following the one, a man does not come back, and following the other, he is reborn.

VERSE 8.27

नैते सृती पार्थ जानन्योगी मुह्यति कश्चन ।
तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु योगयुक्तो भवार्जुन ॥ 27 ॥

naite sṛtī pārtha jānan
yogī muhyati kaścana |
tasmātsarveṣu kāleṣu
yogayukto bhavārjuna ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **ete** – these; **sṛtī** – paths; **pārtha** – O Partha; **jānan** – knowing;
- ◆ **yogī** – the Yogi; **muhyati** – is deluded; **kaścana** – any;
- ◆ **tasmāt** – therefore; **sarveṣu kāleṣu** – at all times;
- ◆ **yoga-yuktaḥ** – steadfast in Yoga; **bhava** – be; **arjuna** – O Arjuna.

**No yogi who understands these two paths is ever deluded.
Therefore, O Arjuna, at all times be steadfast in yoga.**

VERSE 8.28

वेदेषु यज्ञेषु तपःसु चैव
दानेषु यत्पुण्यफलं प्रदिष्टम् ।
अत्येति तत्सर्वमिदं विदित्वा
योगी परं स्थानमुपैति चाद्यम् ॥ 28 ॥

vedeṣu yajñeṣu tapaḥsu caiva
dāneṣu yatpuṇyaphalaṃ pradiṣṭam |
atyeti tatsarvamideva viditvā
yogī paraṃ sthānamupaiti cādyam ||

- ◆ **vedeṣu** – in the Vedas; **yajñeṣu** – in sacrifices; **tapaḥsu** – in austerities; **ca** – and; **eva** – also;
- ◆ **dāneṣu** – in gifts/charity; **yat** – which; **puṇya-phalam** – fruit of merit; **pradiṣṭam** – is declared;
- ◆ **atyeti** – goes beyond/surpasses; **tat sarvam** – all that; **idam** – this; **viditvā** – having known;
- ◆ **yogī** – the Yogi; **param** – supreme; **sthānam** – state/abode; **upaiti** – reaches; **ca** – and; **ādyam** – primeval/original.

The yogi who knows this transcends all the rewards laid down for the study of the Vedas, for sacrifices, for austerities, for making gifts: he reaches the Supreme, Primal Abode.